



THE INSTITUTE OF
MASTERS
of WINE

Stage one assessment (S1A) 2026

Practical paper

Question 1

Wines 1 and 2 come from the same region and the same producer.

For both wines:

- Identify the region. (10 marks)
- Compare quality, clearly stating which one is of higher quality. (25 marks)
- Compare commercial potential. (15 marks)

Question 2

Wines 3 and 4 are made from the same single grape variety and come from two different countries.

For both wines:

- Identify the grape variety. (20 marks)
- Comment on style and quality with reference to winemaking. (30 marks)

Question 3

Wines 5-7 are red blends from three different countries.

For each wine:

- Identify the origin as closely as possible with reference to grape varieties. (3 x 10 marks)
- Comment on style and quality. (3 x 15 marks)

Question 4

Wines 8 and 9 are from two different countries.

For each wine:

- Identify the origin. (2 x 8 marks)
- Comment on the key methods of production. (2 x 7 marks)
- Comment on style and commercial potential. (2 x 10 marks)

Question 5

Wines 10-12 are fortified. None are from Spain or Portugal.

For each wine:

- a) Identify the origin as closely as possible referring to grape variety/ies used. (3 x 9 marks)
- b) Comment on the method of production. (3 x 12 marks)
- c) State ABV in %. (3 x 2 marks)
- d) State RS in g/l. (3 x 2 marks)

Wines

1. Special Cuvée, Bollinger, NV. Champagne, France. (12%)
2. La Grande Année, Bollinger, 2015. Champagne, France. (12.5%)
3. Clos de St Yves Savennieres, Domaine des Baumard, 2020. Loire, France. (13%)
4. Chenin Blanc, David & Nadia, 2023. Swartland, South Africa. (12.5%)
5. Decoy Red Blend, Duckhorn, 2019. California, USA. (14%)
6. The Steading, Torbreck, 2022. Barossa Valley, Australia. (15%)
7. Classic Priorat, Onix, 2023. Catalonia, Spain. (15%)
8. Mühlberg Riesling Eiswein, Dr. Crusius, 2020. Nahe, Germany. (8%)
9. TBA No. 5, Scheurebe, Kracher, 2021. Burgenland, Austria. (6.5%)
10. Banyuls, Domaine de Bila-Haut, 2021. Languedoc-Roussillon, France. (17%)
11. Rutherglen Muscat, Chambers Rosewood, NV. Victoria, Australia. (17.7%)
12. Cape Vintage, Boplaas, 2022. Klein Karoo, South Africa. (17.8%)

Theory paper

Two questions to be answered, **one** from Section A and **one** from Section B.

Section A

Question 1 (Paper 2)

Outline the techniques a winemaker can use to influence the colour of red wine, considering at least three different styles of wine.

Section B

Question 2 (Paper 5)

What are the causes for optimism in the wine world today?

OR

Question 3 (Paper 4)

How important is it for wine producers to develop new products?